Know your Scientist



Dr. Kailasa Vadivoo Sivan was the chairperson of the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) when Chandrayaan-2 was launched. He was born in Sarakkalvilai, in Kanyakumari district of Tamil Nadu. Sivan graduated with a bachelor's degree in Aeronautical Engineering from Madras Institute of Technology in 1980. Then he got his master's degree in Aerospace Engineering from Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore in 1982, and started working in ISRO. He completed his doctoral degree in Aerospace Engineering from Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay in 2006. Sivan is popularly known as the 'Rocket Man' for his significant contribution to the development of cryogenic engines for India's space programs.

Lander

It is named as Vikram in the memory of Dr.Vikram A. Sarabhai, the father of Indian space program.

Rover

It is a six wheeled robotic vehicle named as 'Pragyan' (Sanskrit word) that means wisdom.



Figure 8.9 Lander of Chandrayaan-2

Chandrayaan-2 was successfully inserted into the lunar orbit on 20th August 2019. In the final stage of the mission, just 2.1 km above the lunar surface, Lander 'Vikram' lost its communication with the ground station on 7th September 2019. But the Orbiter continues its work successfully.

More to know

The Moon is the only natural satellite of the Earth. It is at a mean distance of about 3,84,400 km from the Earth. Its diameter is 3,474 km. It has no atmosphere of its own. It doesn't have its own light, but it reflects the sunlight. The time period of rotation of the Moon about its own axis is equal to the time period of revolution around the Earth. That's why we are always seeing its one side alone.

Know your Scientist



Vanitha Muthayya was the project director of the Chandrayaan – 2 mission. She was born on August 2, 1964, in Chennai, Tamil Nadu. She completed her schooling in Trichy and graduated from the College of Engineering, Guindy, Chennai. She joined the ISRO as a junior engineer and has completed over thirty years of service. She has acted as deputy project director for several satellite programmes of ISRO. She was also involved in the successful Mangalyaan mission to Mars in 2013. She is the first woman project director at ISRO.

8.2.4 Chandrayaan - 3

Chandrayaan-1, launched in 2008 successfully reached the Moon. It orbited like an artificial satellite around the moon. Subsequently, the Chandrayaan-2 spacecraft, launched in 2019, experienced a technical fault while landing and lost control. It crashed into the lunar surface.

Chandrayaan-3 was launched on July 14, 2023, from the Satish Dhawan Space Center in Sriharikota as a follow-up to Chandrayaan-2 to fulfill the unfinished goals. The goal of Chandrayaan-3 was to demonstrate the capability of safe landing and roving on the south pole region of the lunar surface. The spacecraft entered the lunar orbit on August 5,

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